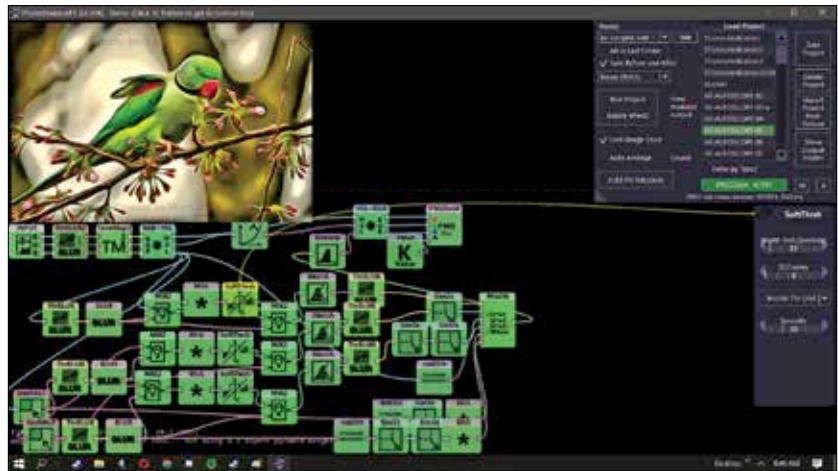


the ADD3 module, and tweak the values as necessary. Then, we will be doing another trick, one of using the data from the green channel for the blue channel in the output, and the data from the blue channel in the green channel. From the ADD3 module to the output module, click and drag a line from the G to B and from B to G. Click on Run Project, and you will have created your first, simple filter using PhotomodularFX.

UNDERSTANDING MODULES

Now let us move on to create a more complicated filter. To do this, you have to understand the various colour spaces, and the advantages of working with all of them. For example, sRGB might be good for working with channels and additive or subtractive colours, but HSL is a more natural way of dealing with and understanding colours. When it comes to creating filters, Yxy is particularly useful, with Y denoting the luminance, while x and y together represent the chrominance. Think of it as a variant of HSL. Depending on what part of the image you want to work with, you have to pick the appropriate colour space module. At the top of the add module box, will be a little drop down menu that allows you to pick from specific types of filters. The software can output in the JPG and PNG file formats. In terms of input, it can accept almost any image file type. If the image has a transparency, it is necessary to choose INPUTA as the input module, as it includes the alpha channel. If the output also requires transparent bits to be preserved, then it has to be the PNGOutA module, as that is the only file format with transparency supported by PhotomodularFX. The INPUT2 module allows you to add another, secondary image to the



A far more complex project with many modules and channels

processing flow. The dimensions will be automatically resized to match the main input image. Then there are the Blend modules, and these are critically important for consolidating parallel flows. This means that if you chain a blur, oil painting and boosted saturation on one channel, and then pixelation as well as increased contrast in another channel, you can mix them together into one output channel using the MIX2 module. Similarly there is a MIX3 module that allows you to blend the image information from three sources. There is also a weighted version of the modules for blending, that allows you to assign a particular amount of importance to one of the many channels in the workflow. Also in the Blend modules is the option to implement a chroma key, or remove a colour from the image. Thresholding is a computing operation where the image is converted to black and white, but at various points of the greyscale. For example a light threshold would mean everything under 80% grey shows as white, while a dark threshold would mean everything over 20% grey is black.

Thresholding is useful in the projects for a number of filters, including those that produce results similar to Prisma. The Art section has much of the magic, the power modules that will be at the heart of the rest of the workflow. These are the modules which give the fancy fx such as oil paint, cartoon, pixellisation, crystallisation or pencil sketches. Overuse too many of these in a single project and the result will just look bad. The important thing is to add modules one by one to check the slight variations in differences. It might be time consuming to figure out the optimum values considering that the values of multiple modules need to be tweaked, and that changing values at any module has a complex effect on the modules upstream or downstream from the module with the modified values. While there are a lot more modules to play with, it is possible to accomplish a lot using only the Color Space, Art and Blend modules. While it is a roundabout way of getting to the results, Photomodular FX also allows you to perform more mundane tasks such as watermarking images or resizing them. 



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